

My brother died suddenly. At the funeral, my mother turned to me and said it should have been me instead — in front of my children.

— shared by a daughter, 30s

WHAT YOU NEEDED TO HEAR

You were never the spare. Losing him doesn't make you worth less, and your grief counts too.

YOUR TURN

Have you ever felt like the “less important” one? What would you say to the younger you who felt that way?

I was crying, and my mom turned to my brother with a smile — “Isn't she so dramatic?” My brother was the one who came over and hugged me.

— shared by a sister, 20s

WHAT YOU NEEDED TO HEAR

Your feelings were never “too much.” The person who comforted you showed you what love is supposed to look like.

YOUR TURN

Who was the kind one in your story? Write down one thing they did that you still remember.

my brother. he sat with me on the stairs and

didn't say anything, just stayed. nobody else

ever did that. i didn't know it then but that

was the safest place i had.

At my high school graduation, my dad leaned over and said, "Just because you accomplished something doesn't mean you're better than me." That was the last day we spoke.

— shared by a daughter, 20s

WHAT YOU NEEDED TO HEAR

Your wins were never a threat to anyone who truly loved you. You were allowed to be proud of yourself that day – and you still are.

YOUR TURN

What's something you accomplished that nobody celebrated with you? Celebrate it here, the way you deserved.

They told me I'd be the first one pregnant and I'd never amount to anything. I own my home now, I was the last to have a baby, and I finish my master's next year.

— shared by a sister, 30s

WHAT YOU NEEDED TO HEAR

Their words were a prediction, not a promise. You get to be the one who writes how your story goes.

YOUR TURN

What did someone predict about you that turned out wrong? Write about who you became instead.